

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line on a treble clef staff in the key of D major (three sharps). The time signature is 2/2, with a 3/2 measure at the beginning of the first line. The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, with some measures containing rests. Above the staff, guitar chord diagrams are provided for each measure: E (1 4 2), B (3 2 1 1), E (1 4 2), B (3 2 1 1), A (2 1), E (1 4 2), B (3 2 1 1), E (1 4 2), A (2 1), and E (1 4 2). The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words hyphenated across measures. The score ends with a double bar line and the word 'Fine'.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...